

Rafael Montero Salazar

Software Engineer — Full-Stack Developer

Costa Rica | +506 8310-2083 | i@rmontero.me | linkedin.com/in/rmontero90 | rmontero.me

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- 14+ years of experience across QA, front-end, and full-stack development, including 8+ years building production applications with Vue.js, React, and JavaScript ES6.
- Strong backend skills with Node.js/Express, Java Spring Boot and Python Django. Monoliths and Microservices.
- Delivered for enterprise clients — Maxar Technologies, Ford Motors, and Subaru — across geospatial, automotive, and global identity systems.
- Experienced integrating AI tooling (Cursor, Ollama, LangChain/LangGraph) into development workflows to accelerate delivery.
- Manages Docker-based server infrastructure (nginx, MariaDB, Redis, AWS) as a developer/sysadmin, including a self-run WordPress hosting business since 2017.
- Prioritizes client visibility into the development process and clear, well-defined requirements flow across teams and meetings.
- Fully remote-capable and comfortable in direct client-facing roles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend: Vue.js, React, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Vanilla JS, Adobe Experience Manager (AEM — HTL, Sling Models, JCR, Clientlibs, Touch UI/Granite UI/Coral UI)

Backend: Node.js, Express, Java, Spring Boot, Python, Django.

Databases: SQL database design and normalization, MariaDB/MySQL, MongoDB (NoSQL — collections and documents)

Frontend Tooling & Libraries: npm, Yarn, Vite, Tailwind CSS, Docusaurus, TanStack Query, Axios

Styling & CSS: SCSS, SASS, Flexbox, CSS Grid, Box Model, CSS Modifiers, Responsive/Mobile-First Design, Cross-Browser & Cross-Device Compatibility, Accessibility (a11y)

Software Engineering Practices: Design Patterns, SOLID Principles, MVC Architecture, Object-Oriented Development, Clean Code, RESTful API Design, Component-Based Architecture, Code Reviews / Pull Requests

Version Control: Git, GitHub, Git Flow, Trunk-Based, Domain Test-Driven and Development.

Agile & Collaboration: Scrum sprints, Jira, Confluence, Sharepoint. Client visibility into development process, clear requirements definition, cross-team meeting facilitation

AI & Tooling: Responsible use of AI-assisted development tools — Cursor, Claude Code, VS Code + Ollama (local models), LangChain, LangGraph, AI agent development

Infrastructure / DevOps: Cloud, VPS Linux servers administration, Bash scripting, Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes (working knowledge), CI/CD pipelines, nginx, UFW, APT, Snap, SSH key-based security, Let's Encrypt SSL, Grafana (familiarity), Azure, AWS (EC2, Lightsail, Cloudfront, S3, IAM), Cloudflare.

QA & Testing: Manual and automated testing, unit and integration testing (Jest, Vitest, JUnit), Storybook, stubs, dependency mocking, spyOn

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer — Gorilla Logic

Project: Internal Project

- Developed React, Node.js and Python applications integrating AI agents built with LangChain and LangGraph.
- Used AI-assisted development tools, including Cursor and VS Code with local Ollama models, to improve development speed and code quality.
- Developed Micro-services with Spring Boot 4 and AI LLM integrations in the APIs.

Client: US-based automotive enterprise client.

Sep 2023 – Feb 2026

- Built and maintained front-end features using Vanilla JavaScript within a large-scale, multi-region enterprise application. Enhanced global Account Identity pages on the Azure platform, supporting users across the Americas, Asia, Europe, and the UAE. Also collaborated with teams across other regions

- Implemented Adobe Analytics tagging tailored by region, country, and language.
- Gave training and knowledge transfer for software development teams in India involves structured approaches that combine documentation, collaborative practices, and formal upskilling to bridge gaps between offshore and onshore teams. Effective strategies include pair programming, code reviews, and mentoring to transfer tacit knowledge, while comprehensive documentation of architecture, workflows, and APIs preserves explicit knowledge.

Client: Maxar Technologies

Aug 2022 – Sep 2023

- Contributed to SecureWatch, a geospatial platform delivering Earth imagery and geospatial information, using Vue.js on the front end and Java Spring on the back end.
- Worked within a containerized development environment using Docker and Kubernetes as part of the team's deployment workflow.
- Participated in the development of the Maxar Developer Portal using Vue.js and Docusaurus.
- Developed client-facing communication skills through direct participation in client meetings, providing visibility into the development process and proposing effective technical solutions.
- Hands-on experience on modules of Java Spring APIs for SecureWatch.

Web Developer — Accenture

Aug 2018 – Aug 2022

- Worked on the Subaru website for client Subaru, part of a client engagement spanning nearly 8 years across QA and development roles.
- Contributed to a front-end redesign project built with Vue.js and Adobe Experience Manager (AEM), working with AEM technologies including HTL (HTML Template Language), Sling Models, JCR concepts, Clientlibs, and Touch UI Dialogs (Granite UI and Coral UI).
- Built cross-browser, cross-device compatible interfaces using a mobile-first, responsive web development approach.
- Refactor the Vue web components to integrate with AEM HTL, Sling Models, JCR, Clientlibs Touch UI, Granite UI, Coral UI.

QA Analyst — Accenture

Jan 2015 – Aug 2018

- Performed manual and automated testing for the Subaru website.
- Lead a team of QA Engineers in Scrum projects.
- Contributed developing a QA/QC Application with Vue.js, which was a task beyond my QA role.

QA Analyst — Critech Research

Nov 2011 – Jan 2015

- Conducted manual testing of medical devices for clients including Mindray, Bayer, and Abbott.
- Requirements analysis and development of Test cases and Test Procedures.
- Code Reviews in C/C++ of medical devices software.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS & SIDE BUSINESS

Founder — Web Hosting & Infrastructure (Self-Employed)

2017 – Present

- Run a part-time side business hosting WordPress sites in Docker containers across multiple VPS providers (Vultr, OVHcloud, AWS), including Eurekafoods, Boutique Galatea, Alcala Novias, and Lucci Boutique.
- Administer Linux servers end-to-end: nginx configuration, UFW firewall rules, and package management via APT and Snap.
- Harden server access with SSH key-based authentication and IP banning/blocking for unauthorized access attempts.
- Use Cloudflare as CDN and proxy for performance, security, and traffic management.

Full-Stack Developer — Boutique Galatea (Wedding Dress Management System)

2018 – Present

- Built and maintain a full-stack application using Vue 3 and Java Spring Boot to manage wedding dress inventory and operations for a major Costa Rica retail store.
- In production since 2018; upgraded to the latest framework versions in 2025.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Software Systems

Universidad Latina, Heredia, Costa Rica — 2007 – 2011

Licenciatura in Software Systems, emphasis in QA/QC (coursework completed)

Universidad Fidelitas, Costa Rica — 2016 – 2018

LANGUAGES

Spanish (Native) | English (C1 – Advanced) | Russian (Basic)